

Day 9: Game Studio Concept Project

Learning Objective: My group can sketch out the HUD for our game.



What is UI?

Read [this article](#) and be prepared to discuss. Take notes in your journal while you read.

Be able to explain:

- Describe what “UI” is and its importance.
- How is UI used in games?
- When should you start thinking about UI in a game development project?
- Why is UI a challenge for video games?
- What UI elements are in your favorite game?

Discuss: What is UI?

Let's call out some of what we learned from:

- Intro to Level + UI Design activity (last week)
- Article (today)
 - Describe what “UI” is and its importance.
 - How is UI used in games?
 - When should you start thinking about UI in a game development project?
 - Why is UI a challenge for video games?
 - What UI elements are in your favorite game?

Watch: The Power of Video Game HUDs

Video Link

Take notes in your journal that will help you design a HUD for your game.

When should you begin mapping out the HUD and UI elements for a game? Explain why.

○ Jot down details that would help you understand the process for designing a HUD or other UI element.

What is the purpose of a HUD and how can one enhance your game?

Day 8: Game Studio Concept Project

Learning Objective: My group can refine our game concept with feedback from others.



Peer Feedback

No judgment space! Be respectful. Groups will have an opportunity to pitch their game concept to another group. The listening group will ask questions for clarification and provide respectful feedback.

Let these questions guide you, and ask any clarifying questions you need.

Is any information unclear about the group's game concept?

Can they clearly describe the game mechanics they will use?

Do you have any questions about their concept?

Are they able to be specific about the details of their game concept?

Day 7: Game Studio Concept Project

Learning Objective: My group can refine our game concept with feedback from others.



Do Now (5 min)

In your group, come up with a 30-second pitch for your game concept. Document this in your journal and prepare to share it with others.

Group 1: Pitch Your Concept

The first group will give their 30 second pitch to the listening group. The listening group will ask questions about the game concept's smaller details, including game mechanics, player engagement, and any other information they are curious about.

The speaking group should be able to describe these details to the listening group. If there's an area where your group gets stuck, make a note so you can flesh this area out some more!

Peer Feedback

No judgment space! Be respectful. Groups will have an opportunity to pitch their game concept to another group. The listening group will ask questions for clarification and provide respectful feedback.

Let these questions guide you, and ask any clarifying questions you need.

Is any information unclear about the group's game concept?

Can they clearly describe the game mechanics they will use?

Do you have any questions about their concept?

Are they able to be specific about the details of their game concept?

Group 2: Pitch Your Concept

The first group will give their 30 second pitch to the listening group. The listening group will ask questions about the game concept's smaller details, including game mechanics, player engagement, and any other information they are curious about.

The speaking group should be able to describe these details to the listening group. If there's an area where your group gets stuck, make a note so you can flesh this area out some more!

Peer Feedback

No judgment space! Be respectful. Groups will have an opportunity to pitch their game concept to another group. The listening group will ask questions for clarification and provide respectful feedback.

Let these questions guide you, and ask any clarifying questions you need.

Is any information unclear about the group's game concept?

Can they clearly describe the game mechanics they will use?

Do you have any questions about their concept?

Are they able to be specific about the details of their game concept?

Day 6: Game Studio Concept Project

Learning Objective: I can apply MDA (Mechanics, Dynamics, and Aesthetics) to my group's game concept.



Do Now (5 min)

1. In your own words, describe the purpose and importance of each letter in the MDA framework (Mechanics, Dynamics, Aesthetics).
2. What is a game vision?
3. How can the MDA framework and game vision come together to create a game? How does each component help keep players engaged?

MDA

MECHANICS

DYNAMICS

AESTHETICS

In other words...

In your groups, add on to the Game Mechanics + Player Engagement section of your notes document by identifying how the game mechanics affect player actions and player feelings in your game.

First, identify your **game vision**. Then identify what mechanics can help guide your game toward this vision. How will your concept make players act? How will it make them feel?



Day 5: Game Studio Concept Project

Learning Objective: I can identify ways to design the gameplay of my game concept.

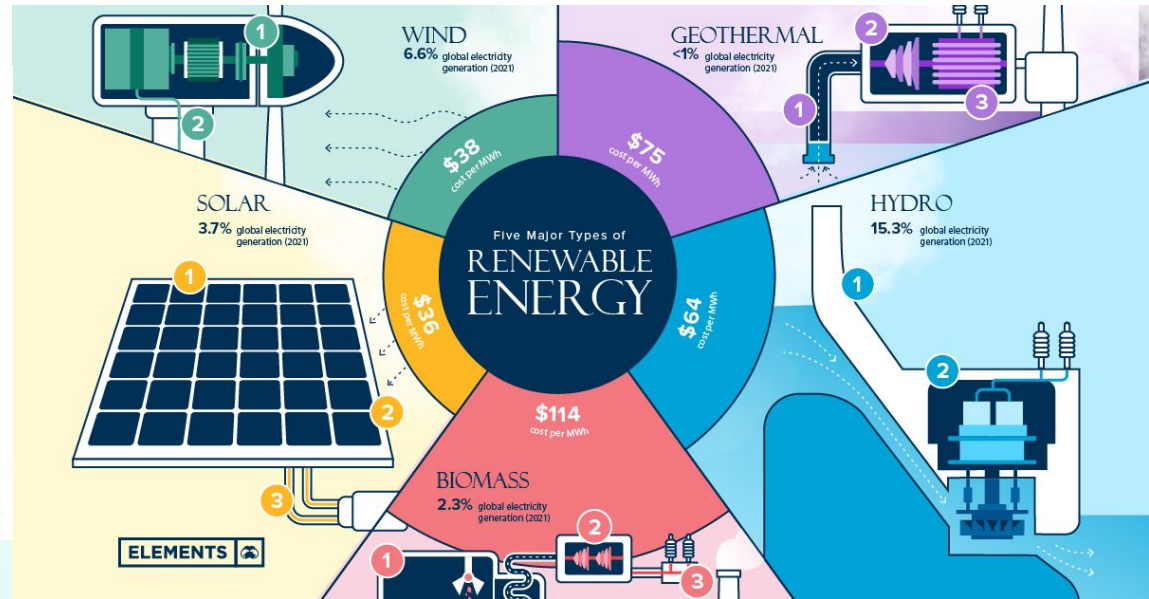


Do Now (4 min)

1. Describe some of the features/functions of your current game concept. What will people be able to do when playing your game?
2. What other games exist that are similar to your game? If your game is unique, think about games that are from a similar genre. (In other words, what other games might someone like if they like your game?)

Renewable Energy + Green Technology

Renewable energy is “energy from a source that is not depleted when used, such as wind or solar power” (Oxford).



Renewable Energy + Green Technology

Green Technology is “an umbrella term that describes the use of technology and science to reduce human impacts on the natural environment” (Investopedia).



How to Think Like a Game Designer

Video Link

While you watch, **take notes** and answer the following in your Notes section of your journal:

1. How can MDA help you design a game? Give examples of how you can use this acronym to help with your specific game concept.
2. Why is a game vision important? Give a detailed explanation.

Share Outs

What did we learn from the video?

How can we apply this to our projects?

Day 4: Game Studio Concept Project

Learning Objective: I can identify opportunities to improve my slideshow based on mine and my group's presentation goals.



Mindful Monday (6 min)

In the Do Now section of your journal, respond to the following prompt:

Reflect on your commitments and responsibilities.
What boundaries can you set this week to prioritize self-care and balance?

Notes Section (Journal)

Identify 3 steps you can take between now and next week to prepare for your presentation.

Write those steps in your journal, and use class time to work toward achieving those goals.

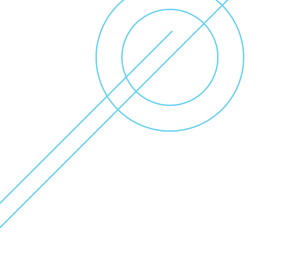
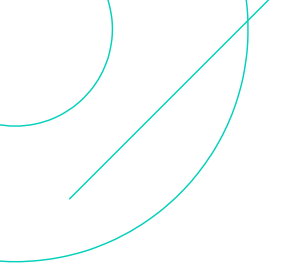
Group Work Time (Part 1)

As a group, identify a primary focus for your presentation (think about the presentation Tips/Techniques we have discussed). Use the assigned document to identify what your group's focus will be for this presentation.

Group Work Time (Part 2)

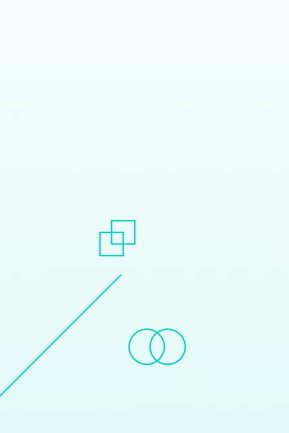
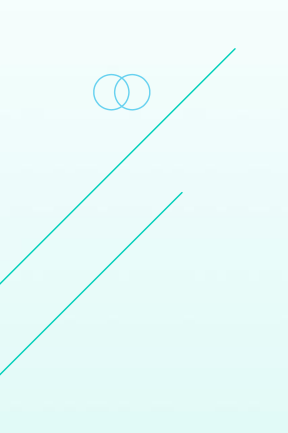
Complete the following sections in your project notes document:

- Game Mechanics + Player Engagement
- Connect it to the Game Development Team
- Story + Characters



Reflection (4 min)

Write out any tasks you still need to complete before giving your presentation.



Day 3: Game Studio Concept Project

Learning Objective: I can describe my group's core game mechanics and tactics for player engagement.



Day 2: Game Studio Concept Project

Learning Objective: I can describe my group's game concept and the concept of game mechanics.



Work Skills Wednesday: Growth Mindset

In your journal, answer the following questions while we watch a video.

1. What is the difference between a growth mindset and a fixed mindset?
2. How can you practice having a growth mindset?
3. In what ways is having a growth mindset helpful in your everyday life?



GROWTH MINDSET

Team Brainstorming (10 min)

In your groups, start brainstorming ideas for your game concept within their chosen category.

Assign someone the role of scribe. This person will type notes for the group while you discuss.

Create a basic game concept. Identify:



- The game's core idea **
- Game genre
- Target audience



** You do **NOT** need to worry about the details at this stage. Capture the essence of your game concept.



Assign Roles

In your groups, you will assign roles based on the roles on a game development team.

Note: Everyone will be helping out across roles, and you may be assigned to more than one. Let your group's strengths guide which roles you are assigned.

Role examples: game designer, game artist, project manager, audio designer, writer, presenter, citation manager, etc.

Player Engagement

Player Engagement is “the interaction, enjoyment, and immersion users experience while playing games” (LinkedIn)

What are some of the ways our favorite games keep us engaged?

Video Link

While we watch, be sure to take notes.



Game Mechanics

Game Mechanics refers to “the rules, elements, and processes that make up a game[...] Game mechanics include player objectives and rewards, character interactions, level design, resource management systems, and more.” (JuegoStudio) Game mechanics affect how a game is played.

How does this relate to player engagement?

Video Link

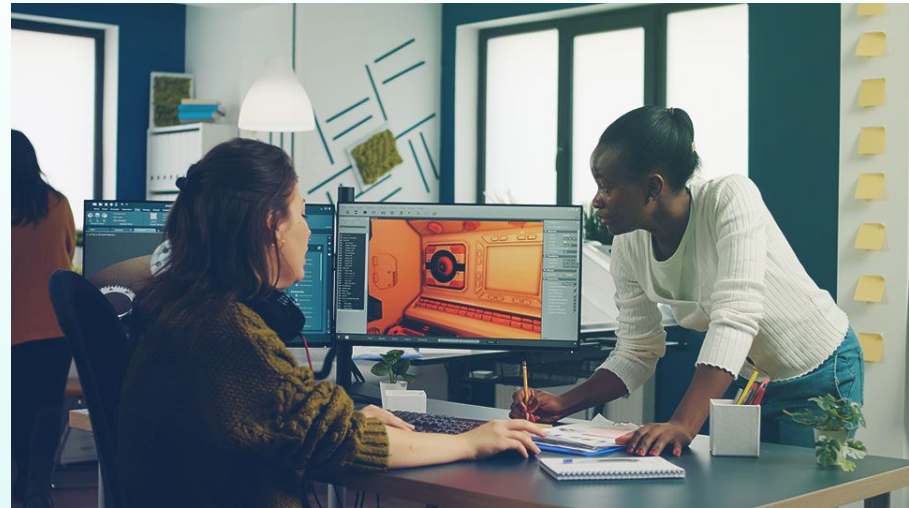
While we watch, be sure to take notes.



How do Game Designers Fit In?

Game Designers are responsible for designing how the game is set up, so their work directly contributes to how players experience the game and what the specific game mechanics are.

Read this [short article](#) about game designers and how they contribute to game mechanics.



Let's Discuss

Game Designers are responsible for designing the mechanics of a game.

What are some examples of game mechanics that you heard about in the article?

What did you learn from the article?



Examples of Game Mechanics

Use the article's and explore the section **Game Mechanics vs Gameplay**.

Note: If needed, this article breaks down the concept of Game Mechanics a bit more for anyone who is interested in hearing it explained a different way.

Your group will split up the work and explore each of the Core, Primary, Secondary Mechanics. In your shared notes document, please define each of the game mechanics listed in the section. There are 14 game mechanics listed, so share the responsibility.

When you're finished, each group member will go around and tell the group what they learned about their game mechanics.

Group Work

Spend the rest of class time working with your group to identify your core game mechanics as well as how your game will engage players. Fill out notes in the **Game Mechanics + Player Engagement** section of your notes.

If you finish early, you may move on to working on the **Connect it to the Game Development Team** and **Story + Characters** sections of the notes document.

Game Studio Concept Project

Learning Objective: I can describe the concept of game development and the roles of different members of the team.



Tech Tuesday: Inside Your Computer

What is going on inside your computer? Let's watch the video to find out.



Do Now (4 min)

1. Describe “game development” in your own words.
2. What work has to be done to create a game?

Game Design Process: Research

Video link

While you watch, take notes on any important details or vocabulary. These notes should help you summarize and describe the content covered in the video.

Also jot down any questions you have about the content.

Game Design Process: Designing Your Video Game

Video link

While you watch, take notes on any important details or vocabulary. These notes should help you summarize and describe the content covered in the video.

Also jot down any questions you have about the content.

Game Concept Categories

Here are some game concept categories. [Click here](#) to see more information about each category.

- | | |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 1. Action-Adventure | 11. Party/Mini-Games |
| 2. Puzzle | 12. Mystery |
| 3. Platformer | 13. Survival |
| 4. RPG (Role-Playing Game) | 14. Sci-Fi/Futuristic |
| 5. Simulation | 15. Fantasy |
| 6. Strategy | 16. Historical |
| 7. Sports | 17. Artistic/Experimental |
| 8. Horror | 18. Multiplayer Online Battle Arena |
| 9. Exploration | 19. Rhythm/Music |
| 10. Educational | 20. Card/Board Games |

Choose a Game Concept Category

In your groups, discuss the different game category concepts and narrow it down to 3 - 5 categories that you are interested in.

Narrow these down to **ONE** final category that the majority is interested in exploring. This will be the category that your game concept will belong to.

Team Brainstorming (10 min)

In your groups, start brainstorming ideas for your game concept within their chosen category.

Assign someone the role of scribe. This person will type notes for the group while you discuss.

Create a basic game concept. Identify:



- The game's core idea **
- Game genre
- Target audience



** You do **NOT** need to worry about the details at this stage. Capture the essence of your game concept.



Reflection (3 min)

1. What does your group still need to identify about your game concept?
2. What questions or concerns do you have about today's content?

Designing Gameplay

Article Link

In the Gameplay section of your group notes document, explain how your group will implement all 13 of the principles identified in the article.

7 Goals and Objectives